

County council briefs

The following issues were discussed at the Dec. 18 Lanark County Council meeting in Perth.

By Sandra Salmins

1997 committees struck

County committees for 1997 were struck during last month's meeting. Reeve Paul Finner of Almonte will chair the Homes for Senior Citizens Committee, in addition to continuing on the Finance and Insurance Committee, and the Special Committee for Waste Management.

Almonte's Deputy-Reeve Terry Gorman will remain on the Economic Development Committee and was again appointed to the Children's Aid Society board of directors.

Ramsay Township Reeve Jim Lowry was appointed to the Roads and Bridges Committee and will again serve on the Leeds, Grenville and Lanark District Health Unit. Deputy-Reeve Cliff Bennett will again serve on the Social Services Committee, in addition to joining the Legislation and Personnel Committee.

The Special Committee for Waste Management, chaired by Harry Barr, will remain the same as in 1996. The Pakenham Township reeve also sits on the Agriculture and Forestry Committee and the Economic Development Committee.

Pakenham Deputy-Reeve Brenda Hurrell was appointed chair of the Social Services Committee and sits on the Homes for Senior Citizens Committee.

From Carleton Place, Reeve Ormond Giles will remain on both the Finance and Insurance and the Economic Development Committees. And deputy-reeve Peter Nephin will serve on both the Property and Planning, and Legislation and Personnel Committees.

Reeve Stanley Brunton (Beckwith) sits on the Finance and Insurance and the Roads and Bridges Committees. Deputy-Reeve Chris Tyson (Beckwith) was appointed chair of the Economic Development Committee for 1997 and will again serve as a member of the Children's Aid Society board of directors.

Councillors hear about amalgamation

Two representatives for the Ministry of Municipal Affairs and Housing, Elizabeth Fulton and Donna Simmons, made a presentation to county council outlining the progress being made by municipalities across the province in the area of preparing individual restructuring proposals.

The speakers reminded councillors that since implementation of restructuring programs is to begin in January of 1998, proposals from all regions are to be submitted to the Ministry by Feb. 14.

Many councillors voiced their concern and frustration with the fast approaching deadline and repeatedly asked what would happen if the county was unable to meet the February deadline despite its efforts.

Fulton explained that the deadline was real, gave examples of regions which had made considerable progress, and suggested that if a region did not meet the deadline that the option of municipally-directed restructuring may be removed and restructuring decisions taken away from municipalities. She offered more than once that ministry staff members are willing and able to help in the development of proposals simply by request.

\$260,000 transferred to roads reserve

The Economic Development Committee requested that council consider transferring its 1996 budget savings of \$3,000 to the committee's 1997 budget for ongoing projects. After some debate, council refused the transfer.

Later the Roads and Bridges Committee presented a bylaw to allow the transfer of the 1996 roads department surplus to the Roads Equipment Replacement Reserve, to the tune of approximately \$260,000. More than \$100,000 is to be used for the purchase of a new truck.

Councillors raised the issue that this department no longer receives specific roads funds from the government. 1996 is the first year council received block funding, therefore allocation of funds can now be directed by council.

Councillors can therefore be more flexible with the budget as it wishes and contribute funds to other important projects in addition to roads, such as job creation and economic development projects.

Rural Addressing

Townships are being asked to reach consensus where duplicate road names have been suggested within the county.

Some municipalities have resisted more changes, but the county says duplicate names will create hazards and liabilities for emergency response personnel.

Draft tree cutting bylaw to be circulated

The draft tree cutting bylaw is currently being reviewed by the Ministry of Natural Resources' Legal Services Branch. There will be a public meeting in January 1997 hosted by the Ontario Woodlot and Sawmill Operators Association. The bylaw will be presented for reading at the February 1997 council meeting.

Plan adds two additional recycling depots in '97

The draft 1997 waste reduction budget includes funds to continue operating the county recycling depot located in Carleton Place and to establish two new depots in the Perth and Smiths Falls areas.

These depots would be open to all residents of subscribing recycling municipalities and would accept materials that are not collected at curbside. The depots will be established if the host municipalities are supportive, and if arrangements can be made to have volunteers or the host municipalities staff the depots.

Waste Management Master Plan document ready

The Stage 3/EA Overview Document is now complete and is available to the public for review through municipal offices and libraries. Notification will be advertised in local newspapers to this effect.

The Special Committee for Waste Management has set a review period for the government agency review at 90 days.

Land Division Committee member reappointed

The Property and Planning Committee received approval to reappoint Jack Virgin to the Land Division Committee as of Jan. 1, for the term ending Dec. 31, 1997. The current policy states that members may sit for six consecutive years. 1997 will be the Almonte resident's sixth year on the committee.

Internet homepage sees plenty of action

This time last year the County was contemplating hooking into the Internet. At this year's December council meeting, one year later, the Economic Development Committee reported that the average number of hits per day to the county homepage during the month of November was 236, making a total of 7,082 for the month.

County Roads gets surplus

Due to low winter maintenance requirements in December 1996, the maintenance portion of the county roads budget will likely have a surplus.

The Roads and Bridges Committee received approval from council to apply any surplus in the maintenance budget against the amount to be financed by the county for roads infrastructure projects.



Florence and Jack Virgin wish their friend Gladys Greenwood a happy 100th birthday at a party in her honour Dec. 27. Greenwood was born on Boxing Day 1896 in Ossett, England. She received birthday greetings from her friends, the mayor and the queen.



The Corporation of the Township of Ramsay

****ATTENTION****

RAMSAY TOWNSHIP RESIDENTS

**PUBLIC
PRESENTATION OF
MUNICIPAL
RESTRUCTURING REPORT**

**Monday, January 13th, 1997
7:30 p.m.
RAMSAY TOWNSHIP CENTRE**

Ross Trimble, C.A.O.
Clerk-Treasurer

CS-AG-CP-2

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The Corporation of the Township of Ramsay

**NOTICE
OF MEETING DATES**

TAKE NOTICE of the following schedule for the month of January, 1997, for meetings of Council and Standing Committees of Council. All meetings will be held at the Ramsay Township Centre, R.R. #2, ALMONTE, Ontario (corner of the Old Perth Road and the 8th Line).

Tuesday, January 7th, 1997 — Council Meeting

Tuesday, January 14th, 1997 — Public Works Committee

Tuesday, January 14th, 1997 — Planning and Development Committee

Tuesday, January 21st, 1997 — Finance, Policy and Administration Committee

Tuesday, January 28th, 1997 — Council Meeting

**All Meetings Begin at 7:30 p.m.
Except Public Works Which Begins at 7:00 p.m.**

PLEASE NOTE: The agenda will be available at the Township Office after 1:00 p.m. on Friday prior to each scheduled meeting, as well as the meeting night. Everyone is welcome!

Ross Trimble, C.A.O.
Clerk-Treasurer

AG-CP-2

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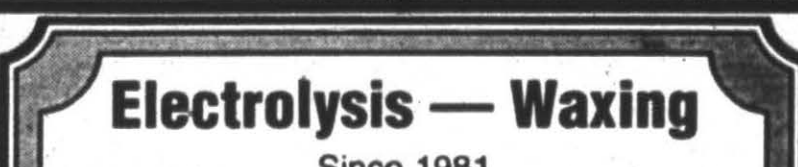
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